

Method, not just the model

The same project, from the other side. Not what the data shows, but how a validated dataset, two dashboards, and two decks actually got made, including where AI helped, where it didn't, and where it got overruled.

Four jobs, each with a check on the other side

1

Extraction

Python scripts pulled figures from HP's press releases and SEC filings. Every number then got checked against the live source page by hand before it went into the dataset.

2

Structure

Suggested the tab layout for the spreadsheet, the dimension tables for the dashboards, and the long-format shape that avoids double counting.

3

Metric ideas

Flagged a few things worth computing, trailing twelve months and growth contribution decomposition, that turned out to be genuinely useful once tried.

4

Formula guidance, not formulas, mostly

For every SUMIFS and XLOOKUP, AI explained the pattern in plain English and I typed it myself. Two honest exceptions: the trailing-twelve-month formula in Sheets is AI's own suggestion and execution, a rolling window I can explain but wouldn't yet write from scratch. And DAX overall, first time I'd used it. I knew of it going in, wanted to see how and why it's actually used, then started learning the basic CALCULATE pattern myself from there.

2

formulas AI wrote outright, the TTM formula and an early DAX measure while I was learning the pattern

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validation checks, all independently checked against source

2

DAX measures that never worked, and got reverted on purpose

Started in the tool I know, then deliberately left it

LOOKER STUDIO, BUILT FIRST

The dashboard tool I use daily at Momentum Data. Built the individual visuals first, mostly the ones AI suggested, then organised them into a broad-to-narrow drill-down myself, three scorecards down to business-unit detail. That structure is mine, not suggested, it's the same one I've used in academic writing, publications, my thesis, long before this project.

POWER BI, BUILT SECOND, ON PURPOSE

Rebuilt the same model in a tool I use less. New interface, first real use of Power Query and DAX in this project, and the two double-counting traps already solved once in Looker Studio had to be resolved from scratch in a completely different tool.

Same underlying model, two different tools. Rebuilding it twice was the point, not a shortcut taken once and reused. The traps stayed the same; how each tool needed to be told about them didn't.

A sort-order problem that took three tries to actually fix

Why Power Query, really

Wanted the region and business-unit stacked columns ordered a specific way, the same custom series sort Looker Studio supports natively. Power BI has no direct equivalent, so the first attempt was a DAX calculated column, a SWITCH-based sort order that hit a circular dependency: sorting a column by a column whose own formula reads that same column. AI suggested Power Query instead, computed at load time, before DAX's dependency graph even exists.

One column, then two, then the real fix

Built one conditional column for Printing versus Personal Systems, then a second for Supplies, Commercial and Consumer Printing. Both read the same `business_unit` column, and Power BI only allows one sort-by-column mapping per column, so the two couldn't coexist. Noticed that myself, then fixed it by building a third column instead, one set of conditions covering all five business units at once, five conditions total, so a single sort order works correctly no matter which chart is filtering to which subset.

What didn't work. Two ratio measures, built to show percent-of-total through filter-context override, never produced a correct result. Debugged at length, including versions with no dependency on any other measure. Root cause never identified. Time-boxed, and reverted to the version that was already correct rather than shipping something broken. That is a real answer to "what was hard here," not a gap to hide.

Built as HTML, styled to match HP's own template, exported to PDF

STYLED AGAINST A REAL REFERENCE

Rendered pages from HP's own Q4 FY25 earnings presentation, sampled the exact blue, the type treatment, and the diagonal corner motif, this deck and the analysis deck both use it. Not a generic template, HP's own visual language.

BUILT AND EDITED WITH AI

Every slide is plain HTML and CSS, drafted and revised with AI over several passes, real numbers checked against the same source files as the dashboards, then converted to PDF with a small HTML-to-PDF converter I built myself as a separate project.

Practice, not a claim to already know this business

Built to refresh Power BI skills, to show initiative ahead of this interview, and to have an honest answer ready for exactly the question this deck exists to answer: what did you actually do yourself, and what did the AI do. The analysis deck is the output. This one is the process behind it.